Browsing for AI agents: market review

(5 slides demo)

Semyon Fast, May 2025

Search trends

The relative volume of the worldwide search requests soared in the autumn of 2024. Since January 2025, it fluctuates around the maximum.

Relative volume (0-100) of the Google Search requests on "ai agents", %

Agentic AI startups funding

AI agent start-ups raised $3.8 billion in 2024, nearly tripling the investments from the previous year.

Disclosed equity deals and funding to AI agent startups

Competitors

Open-source agent browsing solutions are characterized by the higher implementation threshold but cheaper scaling. They are usually monetized by providing credit-based subscription to cloud and UI.

They can be perceived as competitors over: the smallest (and indie) entrepreneurs — don't have money for commercial ones; the largest enterprise — have resources to implement their in-house solution on the open tools.

Name	LOP	Product description	Stars[1], K	Monetization model
Browser use	Agent operates accessible for AI agents. Automate tasks online with ease.	Cloud — CAPTCHA, rotating proxies, persistent sessions, stealth, cheap.	55k	Open source (perhaps commercial subscription for cloud version). Free tier (one API, 500/mo), Dev $25/mo, Pro $125/mo
Stagehand	Browser infrastructure for AI Agents.	Open source headless browser pool.	19.3	Subscription. Free tier (5 concurrent browsers, 1 hour, proxy bandwidth, captcha solves). Hobby $20, Scale $500, Enterprise
Tarsier	Effortlessly extract web data at scale. No code. No maintenance.	Open-sourced, generalized crawl core extractors, detailed results, and crawl data.	1k	
Notegrid.ai	Empowering AI backend engineers to vibe build companies in code. Replay, hot-code, AI agents with human difficulty, production-grade AI agent infrastructure.	Open source AI agent for web automation and scraping. Ai Task, Ai Crawl, Scheduler, hot-to-production AI agents. Browser, Replay Agent — Browser Agent — Crawler Agent — Crawler Orchestrator.	127	Agentic Browser-as-agent service, infrastructure, cloud or enterprise, connected to code.

1. Source: author's own evaluation (stars on GitHub, frequency of mentions)

Strategy for market entrance

Browsing infrastructure market is estimated around $250 – $500 mln in 2024. It is approximately 15% of the overall AI Agents market. It is projected to grow 40% CAGR along with AI Agents.

Also, the quickest grow of interest to the AI Agents topic exhibited in Nov '24 – Jan '25 (Google Search), then stable. But the weekly peak was recorded in May '25.

Strategic note: some of the tier-1 VC already backed browser infrastructure startups. You can either try to capture the rest of "AI agent" hype in the next 2-4 months (fundraising at the high valuation from the not-so-aware VCs) or lay low (develop the tech) until the stump to capture the next wave.

The default monetization model of browsing infrastructure startups is an open-source + cloud subscription. The customer-side flaw of this model is that it combines monthly subscription with credit system. That makes user pay "anyway" in some scenarios.

Strategic note: resort to credit-only model to attract the early stage AI Agent startups customer.

AI Agent developers rather mention the setup issues (beginners) and problems with social media handling (CAPs, captcha, etc.).

Infrastructure providers, from the other side, don't mention the handling of the visual (pictures, videos) content. Presumably, because it creates a pressure on the servers.

Strategic note: browsing infrastructure focused on handling the social media communications (authentication, user-like behaviour to not get banned, processing the large amounts of content) might be the competitive advantage in the current market state. Competitors do not advertise that explicitly in their USPs.